inequalities. Navigating this trail on foot poses numerous challenges that must be confronted.

Confronting these challenges demands profound comprehension, unyielding resolve and extraordinary courage. The nation waited to discern whether Rahul Gandhi possessed those qualities and if he was indeed the beacon of hope this land sought. A disdainful, hate-spreading faction, devoid of the inclination to share genuine affection with the common populace, continued its mockery and mean propaganda.

Yet, in that moment, Rahul sat there with closed eyes, akin to a karma yogi, perceiving only the unfolding path in front of him. Following the prayer, the Indian national flag was entrusted to Rahul Gandhi by the chief ministers of Tamil Nadu, Rajasthan and Chhattisgarh.

For him, the Indian national flag is not just a symbol—it's a creed. As a scion of the Gandhi family, he carries forward a legacy where two great leaders from his lineage sacrificed their lives for the nation. It's a source of pride—the embodiment of dedication, the spirit of sacrifice and patriotism. Back then, the awe-inspiring sight of that flag proudly soaring in Kashmir, triumphing over challenges and hardships, seemed unimaginable.

Initially, I had no intention of completing the entire Yatra due to my chronic knee issues, which limit my ability to cover long distances. However, considering my role as a member of the Bharat Jodo Yatra committee, I resolved to walk only within Tamil Nadu. As the march progressed, on the third night, the Indian national flag crossed the border into Kerala. Reflecting on my fifteen-year journey with Rahul Gandhi, I reminisced about his significant impact on my life, his contributions to the political landscape, and his unwavering support during critical moments.

During our sojourn in Tamil Nadu, we limited our daily walk to a modest 15 kilometres. However, upon entering Kerala, we covered an ambitious 27 kilometres on the first day. In a state of bewilderment, I asked Sateeshan, 'Don't you have any mercy?' Concerns about Rahul's ability to cover the 3,500-kilometre journey to Kashmir arose, but he remained determined, and continued to walk, unyielding to both pain and distance.